



9th-10th Grade

English Language Arts

Learning Standards

9th-10th Grade Introduction

Guidance and Support

Guidance and support are an integral part of developmentally appropriate practice. As children are gaining mastery of the standards in 9th-10th grade, some students may require support to demonstrate skills.

Range of Student Reading Experiences for 9th-10th Grade

Students in 9th and 10th grades should experience a balance of literature and informational texts in the context of instruction designed to create opportunities for learners to engage with a variety of topics, texts, and in discussions about texts that support language development and knowledge building. Creating this learning environment for readers can take a variety of formats, including shared readings, paired readings, independent readings and other learning activities that incorporate literacy materials, talking, and writing. We refer to these instructional events as ‘reading or literacy experiences’ because the focus is on using texts, printed and visual, to develop readers’ concepts of how meaning is conveyed through reading and writing, and in turn their ability to make meaning of increasingly complex text. Much of this work is done through talk-reading and reading-writing connections.

The following are examples of literary and informational text types that could be used in classroom instruction. Texts are not limited to these examples.

LITERATURE: stories, drama, poetry, fiction, myths, graphic novels, and other literary texts.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT: nonfiction, biographies, autobiographies, books and articles about science, art, history, social studies, and information displayed in charts, graphs, or maps, in both print and digital sources.



Text Complexity Expectations for 9th-10th Grade

By the end of the school year, 9th-10th grade students will read and comprehend literary and informational texts that are at or above grade level. Because each reader brings different skills and background knowledge to the act of reading, a text that is ‘complex’ for one reader may be accessible to a peer in the same classroom. For this reason, educators should provide scaffolding and support as needed to allow all students to access grade-level texts.

English Language Learners/Multilingual Learners

English Language Learners (ELLs)/Multilingual Learners (MLLs) enter the school system at all grade levels, with a range of proficiency in English and varying degrees of literacy and academic competencies in their home or primary language. While building proficiency in English, ELLs/MLLs in English as a New Language and Bilingual Education programs may demonstrate skills bilingually or transfer linguistic knowledge across languages. The eventual goal of English Language Arts (ELA) standards is to support the lifelong practices of reading, writing, speaking and listening in English. ELLs/MLLs can receive home language supports and be provided opportunities to demonstrate skills in their home or primary languages to indicate mastery of the linguistic concepts and skills embedded in the ELA standards. Throughout the standards, the use of annotation marks this concept for ELLs/MLLs.

Students with Disabilities

Children with disabilities and their typically developing peers are all capable of learning, achieving, and making developmental progress. Children with disabilities need specially designed instruction and related services designed to address their disability and ensure their participation in age appropriate activities with typically-developing peers. Each child with a disability has an individualized educational program (IEP) which documents his/her individual goals, supports, and services as determined by his/her needs, strengths, and abilities. These individual supports, accommodations, and services are designed to assist the child to meet the goals in his/her IEP as well as to achieve the learning standards. With the appropriate services and supports, children with disabilities can participate in experiences with their typically-developing peers and be held to the same high standards and expectations as those without disabilities.



9th-10th Grade Reading Standards (Literary and Informational Text) | **9-10R**

Key Ideas and Details

- 9-10R1:** Cite strong and thorough textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly/implicitly and make logical inferences; develop questions for deeper understanding and for further exploration. (RI&RL)
- 9-10R2:** Determine one or more themes or central ideas in a text and analyze its development, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details; objectively and accurately summarize a text. (RI&RL)
- 9-10R3:** Analyze how and why individuals, events, and ideas develop and interact over the course of a text.
- In literary texts, analyze how complex and/or dynamic characters develop, interact with other characters, advance the plot, or develop a theme. (RL)
- In informational texts, analyze how the author unfolds an analysis or argument, including the sequence, the introduction and development of ideas, and the connections that exist. (RI)

Craft and Structure

- 9-10R4:** Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in a text, including figurative and connotative meanings. Analyze the impact of specific word choices on meaning, tone, and mood. Examine technical or key terms and how language differs across genres. (RI&RL)
- 9-10R5:** In literary texts, consider how varied aspects of structure create meaning and affect the reader. (RL)
- In informational texts, consider how author's intent influences particular sentences, paragraphs, or sections. (RI)
- 9-10R6:** Analyze how authors employ point of view, perspective, and purpose to shape explicit and implicit messages (e.g., examine rhetorical strategies, literary elements and devices). (RI&RL)



Integration of Knowledge and Ideas

- 9-10R7:** Analyze how a subject / content is presented in two or more formats by determining which details are emphasized, altered, or absent in each account. (e.g., analyze the representation of a subject / content or key scene in two different formats, examine the differences between a historical novel and a documentary). (RI&RL)
- 9-10R8:** Delineate and evaluate an argument and specific claims in a text, assessing the validity or fallacy of key statements by examining whether the supporting evidence is relevant and sufficient. (RI&RL)
- 9-10R9:** Choose and develop criteria in order to evaluate the quality of texts. Make connections to other texts, ideas, cultural perspectives, eras, and personal experiences. (RI&RL)



9th-10th Grade Writing Standards | 9-10W

Production and Range of Writing for 9th-10th Grade

As students in 9th and 10th grades develop their writing skills, they will use a variety of strategies to plan, revise, and strengthen their writing as they work independently and collaboratively with adults and peers to produce texts, and to learn about and develop oral language--written language and reading--writing connections. Students in 9th and 10th grade will write for multiple purposes (to entertain, to explain, to persuade) and learn about various tools (print and digital) to produce, share, and publish writing. In all writing tasks, students will learn to use and to adjust language to best communicate ideas, content, and message to readers; that is, 9th and 10th graders should be clear on the distinction between conversational and academic language and their purposes and use—they should be able to move between these registers and show mastery of most of the conventions of academic language.

Students' academic language skills, including written language, co-develop with content and world knowledge and through opportunities to read, write, and discuss with peers. As part of their writing development, students should continue to learn about how technology and digital tools for writing can increase learning and communication. Students should continue to improve keyboarding skills to increase speed and accuracy. Please see the Lifelong Practices for Writers for examples of important lifelong writing habits that should begin in the early years and continue through life.

Text Types and Purposes

9-10W1: Write arguments to support claims that analyze substantive topics or texts, using valid reasoning and relevant and sufficient evidence.

9-10W1a: Introduce precise claim(s), distinguish the claim(s) from counterclaims, establish and organize clear relationships among claim(s), counterclaim(s), reasons, and evidence.

9-10W1b: Develop claim(s) and counterclaims in a balanced manner, supplying evidence for each while pointing out the strengths and limitations of both, anticipating the audience's knowledge level and concerns.

9-10W1c: Use precise language and content-specific vocabulary to express the appropriate complexity of the topic.

9-10W1d: Use appropriate and varied transitions to make critical connections and distinctions, create cohesion, and clarify the relationships among complex ideas and concepts.

9-10W1e: Provide a concluding statement or section that explains the significance of the argument presented.

9-10W1f: Maintain a style and tone appropriate to the writing task.



- 9-10W2:** Write informative/explanatory texts to examine and convey complex ideas, concepts, and information clearly and accurately through the effective selection, organization, and analysis of content.
- 9-10W2a:** Introduce and organize complex ideas, concepts, and information to make important connections and distinctions.
 - 9-10W2b:** Develop a topic with well-chosen relevant and sufficient facts, definitions, concrete details, quotations and paraphrased information or other examples appropriate to the audience's knowledge of the topic. Include formatting, graphics, and multimedia when useful to aid comprehension.
 - 9-10W2c:** Use precise language and content-specific vocabulary to express the appropriate complexity of a topic.
 - 9-10W2d:** Use appropriate and varied transitions to make critical connections and distinctions, create cohesion, and clarify relationships among complex ideas and concepts.
 - 9-10W2e:** Provide a concluding statement or section that explains the significance of the information presented.
 - 9-10W2f:** Establish and maintain a style appropriate to the writing task.
- 9-10W3:** Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, well-chosen details, and well-structured event sequences.
- 9-10W3a:** Engage the reader by presenting a problem, conflict, situation, or observation, establishing one or multiple point(s) of view, and introducing a narrator and/or characters.
 - 9-10W3b:** Use narrative techniques, such as dialogue, pacing, description, reflection, and plot line(s) to develop experiences, events, and/or characters.
 - 9-10W3c:** Use a variety of techniques to sequence events to create cohesion and a smooth progression of experiences or events.
 - 9-10W3d:** Use precise words and phrases, explicit details, and sensory language to convey a vivid picture of the experiences, events, setting, and/or characters.
 - 9-10W3e:** Provide a conclusion that follows from and reflects on what is experienced, observed, or resolved over the course of the narrative.
- 9-10W4:** Create a poem, story, play, artwork, or other response to a text, author, theme or personal experience; demonstrate knowledge and understanding of a variety of techniques and genres. Explain divergences from the original when appropriate.
- 9-10W5:** Draw evidence from literary or informational texts to support analysis, reflection, and research. Apply the grade 9/10 Reading Standards to both literary and informational text, where applicable.



Research to Build and Present Knowledge

- 9-10W6:** Conduct research to answer questions, including self-generated questions, or solve a problem; narrow or broaden the inquiry when appropriate. Synthesize multiple sources, demonstrating understanding of the subject under investigation.
- 9-10W7:** Gather relevant information from multiple sources, using advanced searches effectively; assess the usefulness of each source in answering the research question; integrate information into the text selectively to maintain the flow of ideas; avoid plagiarism and follow a standard format for citation.



9th-10th Grade Speaking and Listening Standards | **9-10SL**

Comprehension and Collaboration

9-10SL1: Initiate and participate effectively in a range of collaborative discussions with diverse partners on complex topics, texts, and issues; express ideas clearly and persuasively, and build on those of others.

9-10SL1a: Come to discussions prepared, having read and researched material under study; draw on that preparation by referring to evidence to stimulate a thoughtful, well-reasoned exchange of ideas.

9-10SL1b: Work with peers to set norms for collegial discussions and decision-making, establish clear goals, deadlines, and individual roles as needed.

9-10SL1c: Pose and respond to questions that relate the discussion to broader themes or ideas; actively incorporate others into the discussion; and clarify, verify, or challenge ideas and conclusions.

9-10SL1d: Respond thoughtfully to diverse perspectives, summarize points of agreement and disagreement, and, when warranted, qualify or justify personal views and understanding and make new connections in light of the evidence and reasoning presented.

9-10SL2: Integrate multiple sources of information presented in diverse formats (e.g., including visual, quantitative, and oral), evaluating the credibility, accuracy, and relevance of each source.

9-10SL3: Evaluate a speaker's point of view, reasoning, and use of evidence and rhetoric; identify any fallacious reasoning or exaggerated or distorted evidence.

Presentation of Knowledge and Ideas

9-10SL4: Present claims, findings, and supporting evidence clearly, concisely, and logically; organization, development, substance, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.

9-10SL5: Make strategic use of digital media and/or visual displays in presentations to enhance understanding of findings, reasoning, and evidence, and to add elements of interest to engage the audience.

9-10SL6: Adapt speech to a variety of contexts and tasks, demonstrating command of formal English when indicated or appropriate.



9th-10th Grade Language Standards | 9-10L

PLEASE NOTE: Language Standards 1 and 2 are organized within grade bands and are not meant to be accomplished by the end of 9th-10th grade. Local curriculum choices will determine which specific skills are included in 9th and 10th grade. Language Standards 1 and 2 are organized within grade bands. These banded skills can be found in Appendix A at the end of this document. For the Core Conventions Skills and Core Punctuation and Spelling Skills for Grades 9-12, the student is expected to know and be able to use the skills *by the end of 12th grade*. The → is included to indicate skills that connect and progress across the band.

Conventions of Academic English/Language for Learning (See Appendix A)

Knowledge of Language

9-10L3: Apply knowledge of language to understand how language functions in different contexts, to make effective choices for meaning or style, and to comprehend more fully when reading or listening.

9-10L3a: Write and edit work so that it conforms to the guidelines in a professionally recognized style manual appropriate for the discipline and writing type.

Vocabulary Acquisition and Use

9-10L4: Determine or clarify the meaning of unknown and multiple-meaning words and phrases, choosing flexibly from a range of strategies.

9-10L4a: Use context (e.g., the overall meaning of a sentence, paragraph, or text; a word's position or function in a sentence) as a clue to the meaning of a word or phrase.

9-10L4b: Identify and correctly use patterns of word changes that indicate different meanings or parts of speech (e.g., *analyze, analysis, analytical; advocate, advocacy*).

9-10L4c: Consult general and specialized reference materials (e.g., dictionaries, glossaries, thesauruses) to find the pronunciation of a word or determine or clarify its precise meaning, its part of speech, or its etymology.

9-10L4d: Verify the preliminary determination of the meaning of a word or phrase (e.g., by checking the inferred meaning in context or in a dictionary).

9-10L5: Demonstrate understanding of figurative language, word relationships, and nuances in word meanings.

9-10L5a: Interpret figures of speech, including euphemism and oxymoron, in context and analyze their role in the text.

9-10L5b: Analyze nuances in the meaning of words with similar denotations.



9-10L6: Acquire and accurately use general academic and content-specific words and phrases, sufficient for reading, writing, speaking, and listening; demonstrate independence in applying vocabulary knowledge when considering a word or phrase important to comprehension or expression.